

Week 1 — Subject Introduction

CSE5IDP Industry Development Project · Presenter: Scott Mann · Online cohort notes

Semester 2, 2026 · Milestone 1

Delivered by **Scott Mann** (Bundoora, face-to-face stream, live-streamed to online). The online counterpart lecturer is **Ali Abdul Karim**, who ran the equivalent session the night before. Note that the recording cuts off abruptly at roughly 1:50, mid-way through the burndown chart discussion, so the final few minutes are not captured.

The gist of the subject

- Industry Development Project — a capstone framed as the **transition point out of academia into industry**, not just another subject. The deliverable is meant to be a portfolio piece you can talk about for the next 5–10 years.
- Teams of **six**, working on a real industry-partner project with an external project owner.
- Cohort sizes: roughly 29 on campus, 50 online. Staff position themselves as “an extra team member”, not as authority figures.
- Multiple cohorts compete on the same projects — online versus face-to-face, undergraduate versus postgraduate, Bundoora / Bendigo / Sydney / Indonesia. Competition is deliberate and is meant to breed innovation.
- Winners are recognised at the **Engineering & IT Showcase on 18 November**, with awards, industry attendance and headhunting. Letters of recommendation from the project owner and academic supervisor go only to standout teams.

Team formation and project selection

- Roughly half the online cohort was already in teams; anyone unallocated gets **placed by Scott or Ali within a day or so**.
- Project selection opens via an LMS “choice selector” plugin on the homepage, announced by email broadcast the next morning. **First in, best dressed** — cap of about three teams per project.
- Online and Bundoora project lists differ slightly, since some projects need on-campus hardware.
- Selection advice — his three ingredients:
 1. Mix skill sets. Multidisciplinary teams consistently outperform.
 2. Pick something that genuinely interests and motivates you.
 3. Treat it as a vehicle for employability — does it build the portfolio you want?
- Strong repeated point aimed at cyber students: **do not clump together in one team**. Every project needs at least one security person.
- Team-forming tip: work with a couple of people you know, then deliberately bring in people you do not.

Assessment structure

Assessment	When	Notes
Trade show	Week 4 — Thursday 6 August	Virtual booth on Zep.us. Slides due around 9 August

Assessment	When	Notes
Scrum master presentation	Every sprint (6 total)	10 min max, graded on the spot
Compendium (sprint reflections)	Built each sprint, submitted at end	6 individual reflections, zipped
Tender document	Mid-semester	Template provided; argue why your team is best
Final handover	End of semester	Oral presentation plus written reports

Trade show details

Relevant to the online cohort, since it is virtual for everyone.

- Two rubric criteria only: booth materials, and how you engage with visitors.
- Runs in two two-hour blocks on 6 August: **12–2pm and 6–8pm**. You can roster team members across the blocks, but the booth must never be unstaffed — around 200–300 people circulate.
- Each booth has a Zoom link. **You must hit record on your interactions** — that is how oral communication is assessed.
- A sandbox trade show will be released first so you can practise customising, plus a how-to document. Base customisation takes 15–20 minutes. People’s Choice prizes for best booth.
- Friends and family are welcome to attend.

Scrum master presentation contents

1. Intro slide about yourself — professional photo, career goals, certification pathway, target employers. He explicitly said he would give full marks on this criterion for a spreadsheet of roughly six target employers with graduate-intake dates and a certification strategy.
2. Project tracking with **evidence** — Jira burndowns, GitHub commits, actual screenshots of UI, database and app screens.
3. Bugs, issues and team problems — being candid scores well.
4. Task allocation for the next sprint, handed over to the incoming scrum master.
5. Self-reflection on your performance as scrum master.

Key nuance: even a disastrous sprint scores highly if the scrum master can analyse and communicate what went wrong.

Compendium

One reflection template per sprint — burndown chart, story and task points allocated versus completed, contribution summary, retrospective. Roughly 10 minutes each. His big tip: **do not leave these to week 12**.

Sprints

- Six sprints minimum, so every member gets one turn as scrum master. Sprints can be one or two weeks.
- Recommended shape: short sprints at the start (learn your team fast, fail fast), short sprints at the end (laser focus), two-week sprints in the middle to balance other subjects.
- If you run more than six sprints, you still only do six scrum master presentations — the rest just get documented in the compendium.

Tooling — mandatory

- **MS Teams** — a private channel per team, with your project owner invited. Non-negotiable; Discord and WhatsApp are fine as extras, but staff and project owners have no visibility there. Teams channels and a custom **Jira board** get set up for you early next week once teams and projects are locked in.
- **GitHub** for version control. No emailing code, no USB sticks.
- Office 365 for collaborative documents.

Things he emphasised strongly

- **Do not revert to waterfall.** He predicted about half of teams will drift back into it because it feels comfortable. Every sprint must produce a finished, signed-off piece of the puzzle.
- **Security-first / DevSecOps.** Every team must align development to a named framework — OWASP Top 10, ASD guidelines, ISO 27001 or similar. Pick the controls that matter for your project; threat modelling and automated static and dynamic analysis on commits, not bolted on at week 11. He said this is a major CV differentiator and he will lecture on it early in the semester.
- **Test-driven development.** Derive test plans from user story acceptance criteria before writing code.
- **AI use.** Allowed and encouraged as a productivity booster, but not as a substitute for your own judgement. Specific warning about AI-generated trade show posters — over-dense, tiny fonts, obviously synthetic. Iterate and review as a group before finalising.
- **Attendance.** “Teams that stick together, attend together, tend to do well together.” Disengagement shows up fast in project outcomes.
- **The people problem is harder than the technical problem.** Scheduling, accountability and communication are where teams fail — he has seen teams still unable to schedule a meeting by week 12.
- **Do not shoot for the minimum.** Find a point of difference that makes your team memorable to the project owner.
- **Avoid bottlenecks.** Do not stall six people waiting on a project owner reply — they have day jobs and may take a week. Run tasks in parallel.
- **Be authentic in reporting.** Bad burndown charts (the “cliff”, the “lag”, the “gap”) do not cost marks if you can explain them. Fabricating an idealised chart is not acceptable.
- **Mid-semester break.** You are students, not employees — take at least three or four days off. Maybe use a day or two for planning if it reduces later stress.

Action items

Immediate

1. **Read every project description** on your (online) list — highlight the technical competencies and employability outcomes in each.
2. **Get into a team of six** if you have not, or wait for allocation. Introduce yourself on the LMS forum with your skill set and interests.
3. **Watch the LMS homepage and your email** for the project selector link. Move quickly — capacity is capped at roughly three teams per project.
4. **Put Thursday 6 August in your calendar** for the trade show (12–2pm and 6–8pm blocks), with slides due around 9 August.

Within the next week or two

5. Agree a **scrum master roster** (who takes sprints 1 through 6) and your sprint length pattern.
6. Build a **calendar of everyone’s availability** and lock in at least one team meeting per week outside the Wednesday evening online session.
7. Start your **product backlog** — decompose the spec into prioritised functional requirements. Expect the spec to be incomplete; note your questions for the project owner.
8. Attend the **45-minute Q&A session with your project owner**, being scheduled over the next fortnight.
9. Sort out a **professional photo** (headshot, business attire, neutral background — a friend with a phone is fine) and start drafting your career, certification and target-employer plan for your scrum master slide.
10. Connect with Scott on LinkedIn — he offered his 600-plus industry connections and personal introductions.

On your radar

- An external **employability workshop** with ACS and Professionals Australia on how AI is reshaping the graduate job market — date to be announced.
- A possible university **LinkedIn photoshoot** — date unconfirmed.
- Documents Scott promised to release: trade show customisation guide, sandbox trade show

environment, and a lecture on security frameworks.

Online-cohort specifics

- Your weekly touchpoint is the **Wednesday evening session with Ali**, using breakout rooms — the equivalent of the on-campus Friday lab. Scrum master presentations are marked live in these sessions, so attendance matters directly for marks.
- Ask questions freely in the Zoom chat or unmute; Scott explicitly invited it and flagged that he sometimes forgets to check whether the screen share is visible, so speak up if you cannot see something.
- Infrastructure and cloud compute for projects is negotiated case-by-case with the project owner, generally free tier or minimal paid tier.